

Master's Theorem

Decrease function:

$$T(n) = aT(n-b) + f(n), a, b > 0$$

$$\underbrace{\hspace{1cm}}_{n^k \dots}$$

Common Mistakes:

↳ other func can also appear

$$T(n) = aT(n+b) - f(n)$$

If you add 'b' then you will never reach the base case

↳ The cost of composition will never subtract from the cost of decomposition. It will always add.

- Be careful about this, six may use this to trip you.

Case 01:

if $a=1$ then complexity = $O(n * f(n))$

For example,

$$T(n) = T(n-1) + n$$

So,

$$O(n * n) \Rightarrow O(n^2)$$

Case 02:

if $a > 1$ then complexity = $O(n^k * a^{n/b})$

For example,

$$T(n) = 2T(n-1) + 1$$

Rewrite as:

$$= \underbrace{2}_a T(\underbrace{n-1}_b) + 1n^{\underbrace{0}_k}$$

$$\text{So, } O(n^0 * 2^{n/1}) \Rightarrow O(2^n)$$

Case 03:

if $0 < a < 1$ then

complexity = $O(f(n))$

For example,

$$T(n) = \frac{1}{2}T(n-1) + \log n$$

So,

$$O(\log n)$$

Divide function

$$T(n) = aT(n/b) + \underbrace{f(n)}_{n^k \log^p n \dots}, a \geq 1, b > 1$$

Common mistakes

$$n^k \log^p n \dots$$

Other funcs can also appear

$$T(n) = aT(n/1) + f(n)$$

Be careful! you can't reach base case!

Case 01:

if $\log_b a > k$ then
complexity = $O(n^{\log_b a})$

For example,

$$T(n) = 4T(n/2) + 1$$

Rewrite as:

$$= 4T(n/2) + 1n^0 \log^0 n$$

$$a=4, b=2, k=0, p=0$$

Since

$\log_2 4 > 0$ we can use this case

Thus,

$$O(n^{\log_2 4}) \Rightarrow O(n^2)$$

Case 02:

if $\log_b a = k$ then

Case 1:

if $p > -1$ then

complexity $O(n^k \log^{p+1} n)$

For example,

$$T(n) = 2T(n/2) + n$$

Rewrite as:

$$= 2T(n/2) + n^1 \log^0 n$$

$$a=2, b=2, k=1, p=0$$

Since

$\log_2 2 = 1$ we can use this case

Thus,

$$O(n^1 \log^{0+1} n) \Rightarrow O(n \log n)$$

Case ii: $\rightarrow f(n) = \frac{n}{\log n} \Rightarrow n \log^{-1} n$

if $p = -1$ then

$$\text{complexity} = O(n^k (\log(\log n)))$$

Case iii: $\rightarrow f(n) = n \log^2 n \Rightarrow n \log^2 n$

if $p < -1$ then

$$\text{complexity} = O(n^k)$$

Case Q3:

Case i:

if $-1 < p < 0$ then

$$\text{complexity} = O(n^k)$$

Case ii

if $p \geq 0$ then

$$\text{complexity} = O(f(n))$$